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夸克英语笔记

Lesson 45 Of men and galaxies

人生星系 虚拟语气 状语从句

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dispute * / dɪ'spju:t /
subdue / səb'dju: /
envision / ɪn'vɪʒ(ə)n /
latitude / 'lætɪtju:d /
conceive / kən'si:v /
nuclear * / 'nju:kliə(r) /
mosquito / mə'ski:təʊ /
drainage / 'dreɪnɪdʒ /
Morocco / mə'rɒkəʊ /
heretic / 'herətɪk /
suffice / sə'faɪs /
original * / ə'rɪdʒən(ə)l /

引出论点 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-17 02:50:01)

※ In man's early days, competition with other creatures must have been critical.

『man's early days 人类早期』

- **In the pioneering days**, however, this was not the case at all.
- **In the early days** of the settlement of Australia, enterprising settlers unwisely introduced the European rabbit.
- **Man's early days** were marked by constant struggle for survival against the elements. 人类的早期以与自然元素的持续生存斗争为特征。
- The artifacts offer a glimpse into **man's early days** and simple tools. 这些文物提供了对人类早期和简单工具的一瞥。

these days 如今；目前；这些日子	Everything is so expensive **these days**, isn't it? 这些日子，什么东西都这么贵，不是吗?
in those days 在那时；在那段日子里（指过去）	There were no smartphones **in those days**, so people actually talked to each other. 那时候还没有智能手机，所以人们是真的在互相交流。

『**critical** adj. very important 重大的，关键的』

- Practice is a **critical** factor in learning English. 做定语
- Financial support is **critical** to the region's development. 做表语
- The unexpected weather event must have been **critical** to the failure of the harvest. 意外的天气事件对收成失败来说必然是严峻的。

※ But this phase of our development is now finished.

『**phase** n.阶段，期』

- Arthur C. Clark once suggested a revolutionary idea passes through three **phases**: ...
- The wedding marked the beginning of **a new phase** in Emma's life. 婚礼标志着埃玛生活新阶段的开始。
- **The phase** of writing that is actually most important is revision. 写作中真正最重要的阶段是修改。
- We are entering a new era as **this phase of** our development comes to a close. 随着我们发展的这个阶段接近尾声，我们正在进入一个新时代。

※ Indeed, we lack practice and experience nowadays in dealing with primitive conditions.

『**indeed** adv. used to introduce an additional statement that emphasizes or supports what you have just said 事实上；确实/实际上』

- I didn't mind at all. Indeed, I was pleased.
- It would be difficult. **Indeed** it would be almost impossible.
- The report confirms the initial findings; **indeed**, the results are even stronger than anticipated. 报告证实了最初的发现；实际上，结果甚至比预期的还要强劲。

※ I am sure that, without modern weapons, I would make a very poor show of disputing the ownership of a cave with a bear, and in this I do not think that I stand alone.

『**Without** 代替if条件状语从句』

- **Without** something of this kind, searching for intelligences on other planets **would be** like trying to meet a friend in London without a pre-arranged rendezvous and absurdly wandering the streets in the hope of a chance encounter.

『**make a very poor show** 出洋相 / 表现拙劣』

- The candidate **made a very poor show** during the interview. 那位应聘者在面试中表现得非常差劲。
- It's **a poor show** if he forgets your birthday. 要是他忘了你的生日，那可太差劲了。
- The juggler put up such **a poor show** on the music hall stage that he got the bird from the audience. 这个表演杂耍在音乐厅舞台上演得太差劲，因此被观众喝了倒彩。

- Despite months of rehearsal, the lead actor made **a very poor show** of his final performance.尽管排练了数月，这位主角的最后一场演出表现得非常糟糕。

make a fool / an exhibition of oneself 出丑 / 出洋相	He **made a fool of himself** by losing his temper in public. 他在公共场合大发雷霆，出尽了洋相。

『 **stand alone** to be in a position or place where there are no other people 孤立 』

- On this issue, Britain stands alone against the US.
- So long as we stand together, we'll win.
- Don't stand there —give me a hand!
- He'll be standing down as CEO at the end of the year.
- She is going to stand trial for tax evasion.
- No one is taller than those who are willing to stand corrected.

> The Tibetans call it Chomulungma, "Goddess Mother of the Snows". Goddess Mother of the world, actually. In the traditional Tibetan translation. I **stand corrected**. 我接受您的指正。

- There is no need to stand on ceremony —come in and relax.
- If you want to go abroad, we won't stand in your way.
- Facing the difficulty of learning a new language, I do not think that I **stand alone**.面对学习一门新语言的困难，我不认为我是一个人（有同感）。

stands alone 独树一帜 / 独立	This masterpiece **stands alone** as a unique example of Renaissance art. 这件杰作作为文艺复兴艺术的独特范例而独树一帜。
stand together 团结一致 / 站在一起	We must **stand together** if we want to win this fight. 如果我们想赢得这场斗争，就必须团结一致。
stand there 站在那里	Don't just **stand there**; come and help me with these bags! 别只是站在那里，快来帮我提这些袋子！
standing down 卸任 / 退出 / 解除戒备	The CEO is **standing down** after ten years at the helm. 首席执行官在掌舵十年后即将卸任。
stand trial 受审 / 面临审判	The suspect is scheduled to **stand trial** in the High Court next month. 嫌疑人定于下个月在高等法院受审。
stand corrected 承认错误 / 纠正说法	I **stand corrected**; you were right about the meeting time. 我承认我错了，关于开会时间你是对的。
stand on ceremony 拘于礼节 / 讲排场	Please don't **stand on ceremony**; just help yourself to some coffee. 请不要拘礼，随便喝点咖啡。

stand in your way 阻碍你 / 挡路	If you really want to move to another country, I won't **stand in your way**. 如果你真的想移居他国，我不会阻拦你。

※ The last creature to compete with man was the mosquito.

『 **the last creature** 最后的生物(类指) 』

- At last I found this amphibious **creature**. 最后我找到了这个两栖动物。
- The extinction of the giant panda is a reminder that it may not be **the last creature** we lose.大熊猫的灭绝提醒我们，它可能不是我们失去的最后一个生物。

※ But even the mosquito has been subdued by attention to drainage and by chemical sprays.

『 **drainage** 1. [U] process by which water or liquid waste is drained from an area 排水 』

- a **drainage** system
- **drainage** facilities

『 **drainage** 2. [U] a system of drains 排水系统 』

- The **drainage** of the city is not good: some of the pipes are broken.

『 **spray** n. liquid which is forced out of a special container in a stream of very small drops 喷雾 』

- a new hair styling **spray**
- Most farmers use pesticide **sprays**.

『 **be subdued by** 被...制服/征服 』

- The sudden uprising has **been subdued by** the swift deployment of peacekeeping forces.突如其来的起义已被维和部队的快速部署所制服。
- The spread of the invasive plant species has been **subdued by** the introduction of a natural predator.入侵植物物种的蔓延已被引入一种天然捕食者所制服。

人类面临的竞争 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-17 02:57:48) 3

※ Competition between ourselves, person against person, community against community, still persists, however; and it is as fierce as it ever was.

『 **persist** v. 1. if something bad persists, it continues to exist or happen（坏事）持续 』

- If the pain **persists**, consult a doctor.
- The belief that the earth was flat **persisted** for many centuries.
- The habit of procrastination still **persists**, however, despite her best efforts to change.
  尽管她尽了最大努力去改变，然而拖延的习惯仍然持续存在。

『 **persist** v. 2. continue doing sth. in a determined but often unreasonable way 执意做某事 』

- If he **persists in asking** awkward questions, then send him to the boss.
- She was sentimentally attached to this house, for even though it was far too big for her needs, she **persisted in living** there long after her husband's death.

persist in doing sth. 坚持做某事 / 执意做某事	If you **persist in ignoring** my advice, you will eventually regret it. 如果你执意不听我的建议，你最终会后悔的。

『 **fierce** adj. involving a lot of force or energy （竞争等）激烈的 』

- We face **fierce** competition from overseas competitors.
- There was **a fierce opposition** of the proposal.

人类相互竞争的特征 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-17 03:50:23) 4

※ But the competition of man against man is not the simple process envisioned in biology.

『 **envision** v.设想 』

- The phenomenon is far more complex than the model **envisioned in** biology.这种现象比生物学中设想的模型要复杂得多。
- Don't compromise on the ideal you **envision** in order to get an ally.Stick to your cause and press forward.不要为了找寻同盟者而让你的理想妥协，坚持你的信念，奋力向前。
- They **envision** an equal society, free of poverty and disease. 他们向往一个没有贫穷和疾病的平等社会。

※ It is not a simple competition for a fixed amount of food determined by the physical environment, because the environment that determines our evolution is no longer essentially physical.

『 **competition for sth.** 对某事物的竞争 / 争夺 』

- There is fierce **competition for the limited number** of jobs available. 对有限工作岗位的竞争非常激烈。
- **Competition for** the job was intense.
- We're in competition with several other **companies for** the contract.

『 **fixed** adj. fixed times, amounts, meanings etc. cannot be changed 固定不变的 』

- The contract is for **a fixed period** of three years.
- The interest rate on the loan is **fixed**.

a fixed price 固定价格	The contractor agreed to complete the renovation for **a fixed price**. 承包商同意以固定价格完成装修工程。

『 **physical** adj. connected with things that actually exist or are present and can be seen, felt, etc. rather than things that only exist in a person's mind 物质的，实实在在的，真实而具体的，看得见摸得着的 』

- the **physical** world
- environment **physical** weapons
- Is there any **physical evidence** to suggest that a crime has been committed?
- The early migration patterns were largely determined by **the physical environment** and climate.早期的迁徙模式主要由物理环境和气候决定。
- Modern warfare is no longer essentially **physical**, relying heavily on cyber capabilities.
  现代战争本质上不再是物理性的，严重依赖网络能力。

※ Our environment is chiefly conditioned by the things we believe.

『 **condition** v. have an important effect on sb. / sth., determine 对...有重要影响，决定 』

- We **are** all **conditioned by** the society and age we live in.
- What I buy **is conditioned by** the amount I earn.
- The success of the project **was chiefly conditioned by** the amount of funding received.项目的成功主要受收到的资金数额所制约。

  A country's political stability **is chiefly conditioned by** the strength of its democratic institutions.一个国家的政治稳定主要受其民主机构的强度所制约。

be conditioned by ... 受...的影响 / 受...的制约	Our behavior is often **conditioned by** the social environment in which we live. 我们的行为往往受我们所处的社会环境的影响。

※ Morocco and California are bits of the Earth in very similar latitudes, both on the west coasts of continents with similar climates, and probably with rather similar natural resources.

『 **latitudes** n. [pl] an area at a particular latitude 纬度地区 』

- The birds breed **in** northern **latitudes**.
- The plant grows best **in** cooler **latitudes**.

in ... latitudes 在...纬度地区	The aurora borealis is most frequently seen **in high latitudes** during the winter. 北极光在冬季的高纬度地区最为常见。

『 **on the west coasts of continents** 在大陆的西海岸 』

- a town **on the south coast of** England
  a thriving holiday resort **on the east coast of** Italy.
- Many major cities are situated **on the west coasts of** continents due to favorable ocean currents.由于有利的洋流，许多主要城市都位于大陆的西海岸。

※ Yet their present development is wholly different, not so much because of different people even, but because of the different thoughts that exist in the minds of their inhabitants.

『 **not so much because of... but because of...** 与其说是由于...不如说是由于... 』

- He left the job **not so much** because of the low salary, **but** because of the toxic work environment.他辞职与其说是由于薪水低，不如说是由于有毒的工作环境。
- The market shift occurred **not so much** because of competition, **but** because of a change in consumer habits.市场的转变与其说是由于竞争，不如说是由于消费者习惯的改变。

not so much ... as ... 与其说是...不如说是...	• She's **not so much** poor **as** careless with money. • The details are **not so much** wrong **as** they are incomplete.

『 **even** 语气副词（根据中文习惯翻译） 』

- The holidays ended **all** too soon.假期结束得实在是太快了。
- I'm **only** too ready to help you. 我实在是非常乐意帮助您。
- I did **so** see him.我确实看到他了。
- No, I won't help you, **so** there?不，我不想帮助你，你拿我怎么样?

※ This is the point I wish to emphasize.

『 **wish to do sth. (fml.) = want to do sth. = like to do sth.** 希望做某事 』

- She **wishes to be** alone.
- I **wish to make** a complaint.
- If you **wish to attend** the seminar, please register by Friday. 如果你希望参加研讨会，请在周五前注册。
- Let me reiterate the point I **wish to emphasize**: deadlines are non-negotiable.让我重申我希望强调的观点：截止日期不容商议。

want to do sth. 想要做某事	I **want to travel** around the world one day. 我想有一天去环游世界。
like to do sth. 喜欢做某事	I **like to read** historical novels in my spare time. 我喜欢在闲暇时间读历史小说。

※ The most important factor in our environment is the state of our own minds.

『 **the state of our own minds** 我们自己的心智状态 』

- Maintaining a positive **state of our own minds** is essential for creativity and productivity.保持积极的心智状态对于创造力和生产力至关重要。
- **The state of** employment in this city is improving. 这个城市就业状况正在改善。
- Measure **the state of** women's progress. 衡量一下妇女的进步状况。

结论 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-17 07:23:24) 7

※ It is well known that where the white man has invaded a primitive culture, the most destructive effects have come not from physical weapons but from ideas.

『 **man** n. a person, either male or female —used esp. in formal situations or in the past 人 』

- **All men** are equal in the eyes of the law.
- Growing old is something **a man** has to accept.

『 **come from / of (doing) sth.: be the result of sth.** 因为，是...的结果，来自于 』

- His air of confidence **came from** his firm belief that he was the best candidate for the job.
- It's the kind of accident that **comes from** being careless.
- I did ask a few questions, but nothing **came of** it.
- That **comes of** eating too much!
- That's what **comes of** not practicing — you've forgotten everything!

come of 由...引起；是...的结果	I'm sure that nothing but good will **come of** your hard work. 我确信你的努力只会带来好的结果。

※ Ideas are dangerous. The Holy Office knew this full well when it caused heretics to be burned in days gone by.

『 **the Inquisition / Holy Office** 宗教法庭 』

> a Roman Catholic organization in the past whose aim was to find and punish people who had unacceptable beliefs.

- In his own lifetime Galileo was the centre of violent controversy; but the scientific dust has long since settled, and today we can see even his famous clash with **the Inquisition** in something like its proper perspective.

『 **know sth. full well / very well / perfectly well** 非常清楚...心知肚明 / 完全清楚 』

- Preachers pray for rain, **knowing full well** that no such prayer was ever answered.
- You **know very well** what I'm talking about!
- I **knew perfectly** well it was a trap.

- I knew f**ull well** / **very well** / **perfectly well** that it was a risky investment, but I decided to take the chance. 我心知肚明那是项高风险投资，但我还是决定冒险一试。
- She **knew** this f**ull well** that delaying the repair would lead to greater problems later. 她非常清楚，推迟修理会在以后导致更大的问题。

『 **cause** v. to compel by command, authority, or force 逼迫，迫使 』

- The king **caused** him **to** resign.
- The moderator invoked a rule **causing** the debate **to** be ended.

cause sb. to do sth. 导致某人做某事 / 使某人做某事	The heavy rain **caused the driver to lose control** of the vehicle. 大雨导致司机失去了对车辆的控制。

『 **in days / times / years gone by = in the past** 在过去 / 在往昔 』

- **In times gone by**, all crops were harvested by hand.
- These herbs would have been grown for medicinal purposes **in days gone by**.
- Life was simpler **in days gone by**, before the invention of the internet. 在过去的日子里，在互联网发明之前，生活更简单。
- **In days gone by**, it was common for families to live under one roof for several generations. 在往昔岁月里，几代人同住一个屋檐下是很平常的事。

『 **let bygones be bygones** to forget sth. bad that someone has done to you and forgive them 不计前嫌，既往不咎 』

- Forget it, **let bygones be bygones**. 算了，过去的事就让它过去吧。
- Don't be sad. **Let bygones be bygones**. 别难过了，过去的就让它过去吧！
- How about we **let bygones be bygones** and start over? 不如我们既往不咎，重新开始?

※ Indeed, the concept of free speech only exists in our modern society because when you are inside a community, you are conditioned by the conventions of the community to such a degree that it is very difficult to conceive of anything really destructive.

『 **free speech = freedom of speech** n. the right to express any opinion in public without censorship or restraint by the government 言论自由 』

- The university provides a safe space for students to exercise their right to **free speech**. 大学为学生行使言论自由权提供了一个安全的空间。
- The ruling was a welcome affirmation of the constitutional **right to free speech**. 此裁决是对言论自由这一宪法权利的受人欢迎的肯定。
- Many experts in constitutional law have warned that the rule violates the **right to free speech**. 很多宪法专家已警告说，该条例违反了言论自由权。

freedom of speech 言论自由	**Freedom of speech** is considered a fundamental human right in most democratic societies. 在大多数民主社会中，言论自由被视为一项基本人权。

『 **to such a degree / extent that ...** 到如此程度以至于... 』

- Her condition deteriorated to **such** a degree **that** a blood transfusion was considered necessary.
- It is a harmless habit, but it litters up her desk to **such** an extent **that** every time she opens it, loose bits of paper fall out in every direction.
- Sometimes the secrecy goes to **such** an extent **that** the whole nature of the research cannot be mentioned.
- The pollution has increased **to such an extent that** the river is no longer safe for swimming. 污染已增加到如此程度，以至于这条河不再适合游泳了。
- The market changed to **such** a degree **that** the original business model was no longer viable. 市场变化到了如此程度，以至于最初的商业模式不再可行。

『 **conceive** v. (fml.) to imagine a particular situation or to think about something in a particular way 想象，设想 』

- It is difficult to **conceive** how the situation could get any worse. 很难想象情况还会变得多么糟糕。
- It is hard for people living in peace to **conceive of anything** really destructive like a large-scale conflict. 对于生活在和平中的人来说，很难构想出任何真正具有破坏性的事物，比如大规模冲突。

conceive of sth. 想象某事	Many people cannot **conceive of** a world without the internet. 许多人无法想象一个没有互联网的世界。

※ It is only someone looking on from outside that can inject the dangerous thoughts.

『 **looking on = stand by** 旁观 』

- Only one man tried to help us, the rest just **looked on** / **stood by** in silence.
- The report provided a critical perspective by **looking on** from outside the company's internal politics. 这份报告通过从公司内部政治的外部观察，提供了批判性的视角。

onlooker / bystander 旁观者	A curious crowd of **onlookers** gathered at the scene of the accident. 一群好奇的旁观者聚集在事故现场。
look on ... as ... 把...看做...	• We **look on** her **as** a daughter. • They **look on** the new mentor **as** a father figure. 他们把这位新导师看作父亲般的人物。
stand by sb. 支持帮助某人	He **stood by** her through the difficult times.

『**inject** v. to add something new to a situation 注入…』

- Young staff are **injecting** new life into the company.
- Try to **inject** confidence into your voice.
- Propaganda aims to **inject the dangerous thoughts** of division and hatred into the public discourse.宣传旨在向公共话语中注入分裂和仇恨的危险思想。

※ I do not doubt that it would be possible to inject ideas into the modern world that would utterly destroy us.

『**utterly** adv.完全地，彻底地』

- This was **utterly** beyond her comprehension. 这完全超出了她的理解力。
- Their life seemed **utterly** distant from his own. 他们的生活与他自己的生活似乎完全不同。
- Tom was **utterly** indiscreet, and could never keep a secret. 汤姆言行完全不慎重，从来守不住秘密。
- The unexpected natural disaster had the potential to **utterly** destroy us if not for the early warning systems.如果不是早期预警系统，这场意料之外的自然灾害有可能彻底摧毁我们。

utter adj.完全的，彻底的	You may pick them up in **utter** exhaustion, if wind over the sea has driven them to a long journey.

※ I would like to give you an example, but fortunately I cannot do so. Perhaps it will suffice to mention the nuclear bomb.

『**suffice to mention** 提及…就足够了』

- This single item will **suffice to** typify all the rest. 即此一端， 可概其余。
- Word will **suffice to** convey his grief. 他的悲伤足以用言辞表达。
- The money will **suffice to** keep her alive. 这些钱足以维持她的生活。
- When explaining the concept, it will **suffice to mention** the core principle without delving into the complex mathematics.在解释这个概念时，提及核心原理就足够了，而无需深入复杂的数学。

※ Imagine the effect on a reasonably advanced technological society, one that still does not possess the bomb, of making it aware of the possibility, of supplying sufficient details to enable the thing to be constructed.

『**reasonably** adv. 1. in a reasonable way 合理地，合乎逻辑地』

- discuss the matter calmly and reasonably

『**reasonably** 2. to a fairly high degree, level, or standard = fairly 相当地，颇为』

- We are reasonably sure this is the best solution.

reasonably good / accurate / clear 相当好 / 准确 / 清楚	The weather forecast turned out to be **reasonably accurate** for most of the week. 天气预报在这一周的大部分时间里都证明是相当准确的。

『 **the effect / influence / impact of ... on / upon ...** ...对...的影响 / 作用 』

- the **influence of** parents **on** their children
- the **effect of** fertilizers **on** the crops
- the **impact of** the oil spill **on** marine life
- The study explores **the impact of** social media **on** the mental health of teenagers. 这项研究探讨了社交媒体对青少年心理健康的影响。
- In the organization of industrial life **the influence of** the factory **upon** the physiological and mental state of the workers has been completely neglected.
- This result merely confirms earlier American and British studies: if there is any **effect of** noise **upon** mental health, it must be so small that present methods of psychiatric diagnosis cannot find it.
- Snakes did not acquire their poison for use against man but for use against prey such as rats and mice, and the **effects on** these **of** viperine poison is almost immediate.

※ Twenty or thirty pages of information handed to any of the major world powers around the year 1925 would have been sufficient to change the course of world history.

『 **power** n. a country that is strong and important and can influence events, or that has a lot of military strength 大国， 强国 』

- Egypt is still a major **power** in the Middle East.
- Zheng He's seven expeditions established China as the world's **top naval power**.
- The summit brought together leaders from all **the major world powers** to discuss climate change.这次峰会汇集了所有世界主要大国的领导人，讨论气候变化问题。

『 **superpower** n. any of the most powerful nations in the world, esp. the USA or former USSR 超级大国 』

- Since the disintegration of the USSR, there has been only one **superpower** — the USA.

『 **if 从句（虚拟语气）** 』

- If twenty or thirty pages of information **had been handed** to any of the major world powers around the year 1925, it **would have been** sufficient to change the course of world history.与过去事实相反
- If twenty or thirty pages of information **had been handed** to any of the major world powers around the year 1925, the course of world history **would have been changed**.
  替换成被动

- **Had** twenty or thirty pages of information **been handed** to any of the major world powers around the year 1925, it **would have been** sufficient to change the course of world history. 倒装
- **Had** twenty or thirty pages of information **been handed** to any of the major world powers around the year 1925, the course of world history **would have been changed**. 倒装+被动

『 **be sufficient to do sth.** 足以做某事 』

- The evidence collected by the police was **sufficient to convict** the suspect. 警方收集的证据足以定罪该嫌疑人。
- The money is not **sufficient to** cover everything that needs doing.
- A simple apology would have been **sufficient to** resolve the misunderstanding. 一个简单的道歉本来就足够解决这个误会。

※ It is a strange thought, but I believe a correct one, that twenty or thirty pages of ideas and information would be capable of turning the present-day world upside down, or even destroying it.

『 **present-day** adj. existing now 当今的 』

- The amount of money is small by **present-day** standards.
- The novel is set in **present-day** Russia.

『 **upside down** adv. with the top at the bottom and the bottom at the top 颠倒，翻转 』

- To get the plant out of the pot, turn it **upside down** and give it a gentle knock.
- The sudden technological breakthrough risks turning the present-day world **upside down**. 突如其来的技术突破有颠覆当今世界的风险。
- She looked at it critically for a moment. "It's all right," she said, "but isn't it **upside down**?"

『 **upside-down** adj. with the upper part underneath instead of on top 上下翻转过来（的） 』

- That picture is **upside-down**.
- As I looked at **the upside-down pizza**, I heard Mrs. Martin's voice. 当我看着打翻的披萨时，我听到了马丁太太的声音。
- Transfer the cake **upside-down** to the cake board. 把蛋糕倒过来放到蛋糕板上。

※ I have often tried to conceive of what those pages might contain, but of course I cannot do so because I am a prisoner of the present-day world, just as all of you are.

『 **prisoner of** ...的囚徒/ 受制于...的人 』

- It is easy to become **a prisoner of** your own past mistakes if you don't learn to forgive yourself. 如果你不学会原谅自己，很容易就会成为过去错误的囚徒。

- The lack of imagination meant the artist felt like **a prisoner of** the present-day world, unable to escape current trends.缺乏想象力意味着这位艺术家感觉自己是当今世界的囚徒，无法摆脱当前的潮流。

※ We cannot think outside the particular patterns that our brains are conditioned to, or, to be more accurate, we can think only a very little way outside, and then only if we are very original.

『 **condition** v. 1. have an important effect on sb. / sth., determine 对...有重要影响，决定 』

- We are all **conditioned** by early impressions and experiences. 我们都受早年印象和经历的长期影响。
- I just feel women are **conditioned** into doing housework. 我只是觉得女人习惯于做家务。

『 **condition** v. 2. to train or influence a person or animal mentally so that they do or expect a particular thing without thinking about it 训练或影响...使习惯或适应... 』

- Pavlov **conditioned** dogs **to** salivate at the sound of a bell.
- Many women are **conditioned** from birth **to** be accepting rather than questioning.
- It didn't take them long to become **conditioned to** the new environment.
- Patients can become **conditioned to** particular forms of treatment.
- Most people are **conditioned** to use their phones immediately upon waking up.大多数人习惯于在醒来后立即使用手机。

condition sb. to do sth. 训练/使某人习惯于做某事	From a young age, children are often **conditioned to seek** approval from their peers. 从很小的时候起，孩子通常就习惯于寻求同伴的认可。
condition sb. to sth. 使某人习惯于某事	Years of living in a noisy city had **conditioned him to the constant roar** of traffic. 多年在嘈杂的城市生活，已经让他习惯了不断的交通喧嚣。

『 **conditioning** n. 潜移默化的影响 』

- **Conditioning** starts as soon as boys are given guns to play with and girls are given dolls.
- Social **conditioning** makes crying more difficult for men.
- After years of **conditioning**, most of us have developed an unshakable faith in railway time-tables.

『 **then** adv. used to add sth. to what you have just mentioned 此外，而且 』

- It costs $20, **and then** there's the sales tax to pay.
- We have to invite your parents and my parents, **and then** there's your brother.

and then 然后 / 接着	First, you need to preheat the oven, **and then** you can start preparing the ingredients. 首先，你需要预热烤箱，然后就可以开始准备食材了。

『 **only if ...** 只有... 』

- The missiles can be fired **only if** the operator types in a six-digit code.
- If you are younger, and in a solid financial position, you may decide to take an aggressive approach, but **only if** you're blessed with a sanguine disposition and won't suffer sleepless nights over share prices.
- she will go **only if** he goes. ⇒ **Only if** he goes will she go. 引起部分倒装
- The funding will be released **only if** we are very original in our approach to the problem.
  只有在我们解决问题的方法非常具有独创性时，资金才会被发放。

『 **original** adj. able to produce new ideas, creative 有创见的，有创造力的 』

- the product of a highly **original** mind
- It is one of the most **original** works of imagination in the language. 这是用这种语言创作的最具想像力的原创作品之一。

an original thinker / writer / painter 有原创精神的思想家/作家/画家	She is considered **an original thinker** who isn't afraid to challenge conventional wisdom. 她被认为是一位具有原创精神的思想家，敢于挑战传统观念。



Your guess is as good as mine

我也不知道；我也在纳闷

Idioms